

## Fish and Fish Habitat Program Engagement Fact Sheet

**Framework to Identify Fish Habitat Restoration Priorities**

## Purpose of Engagement

Fisheries and Oceans Canada (DFO) is developing an approach for identifying and prioritizing fish habitat restoration actions, opportunities and objectives. In this phase of engagement (May to June 2022), we are sharing information about our plan to identify fish habitat restoration priorities. We are seeking your feedback on a proposed approach to identify fish habitat restoration priorities and what factors to consider in selecting priority restoration actions, opportunities, and objectives.

We are seeking input from Indigenous Peoples, partners, and stakeholders to help inform the approach. Your input will be used to improve the proposed approach to identify fish habitat restoration priorities.

## Description

Fish habitat restoration can address habitat degradation, improve biodiversity, and mitigate climate change impacts. Various parties contribute to fish habitat restoration, including Indigenous Peoples, communities, conservation and environmental organizations and governments who undertake aquatic restoration across Canada.

DFO supports restoration through funding programs such as the Coastal Restoration Fund, and through participation in integrated planning processes such as watershed planning. DFO has a role in undertaking restoration directly to restore habitat for Pacific Salmon in British Columbia and Yukon Territory, and through aquatic invasive species management, including Sea Lamprey control in the Great Lakes and certain control projects on the Pacific and Atlantic coasts.

Under the *Fisheries Act*, negative impacts to fish and fish habitat from projects in or near water, that cannot be avoided or mitigated, must be counterbalanced through habitat offsetting or habitat banking. DFO has experience reviewing restoration plans and identifying monitoring requirements for offsetting and habitat banking projects.

Identifying restoration priorities will support the planning phase of the restoration process and will help to align priorities to support fish habitat restoration objectives. Restoration priorities will provide landscape or regional level suggestions to target restoration actions that make best use of resources and improve overall outcomes for fish and fish habitat.

Establishing priorities for aquatic restoration will help DFO and others select and target restoration opportunities to improve fish habitat. The overall goal is to improve outcomes for fish and fish habitat and to make the best use of restoration resources.

Restoration priorities will be identified in two parts:

1. **Framework to Identify Fish Habitat Restoration Priorities** – aims to identify restoration principles, outline a broad and flexible approach for the identification and prioritization of restoration actions, opportunities or objectives at a regional level, and identify considerations to influence priority selection of restoration opportunities.

DFO is engaging now (May and June 2022) and gathering information to develop the Framework.

Please direct any questions or concerns regarding engagement to:

[DFO.FFHPP-PPPH.MPO@DFO-MPO.GC.CA](mailto:DFO.FFHPP-PPPH.MPO@DFO-MPO.GC.CA)



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2. Regional Fish Habitat Restoration Plans - developed by DFO Regions to identify restoration actions, opportunities or objectives and apply regional criteria to select priorities. These plans will follow the approach set out in the Framework. In some Regions, site-specific restoration opportunities may be identified (e.g. replacing a specific culvert), while in other Regions the focus may be on restoration objectives for a larger area (e.g. improve connectivity in a geographical area). Regional Fish Habitat Restoration Plans may be scoped to areas where restoration would have high impact. These plans will be evergreen, and will be updated as new information is available.

There are seven Regions in DFO, which can be seen [on a map](#).

DFO will engage on these regional plans in 2023.

## Key topics for your input

We are very interested in hearing your feedback on this proposed approach to identify restoration priorities. Please send any feedback you may have by using one of the methods listed at the bottom of this page.

### Discussion Questions

1. What factors are important to consider for selecting restoration priorities?
2. Do you have any other comments related to the this proposed approach proposed in the presentation material? to identifying restoration priorities?

## How to get involved

There are a number of ways that you can get involved and share your insights and comments with us. You can submit comments to our Engagement email address or participate in a technical presentation and ask questions or share feedback.

Visit [www.talkfishhabitat.ca](http://www.talkfishhabitat.ca) for more resources and to share your thoughts.

Please direct any questions or concerns to the Fish and Fish Habitat Protection Program at:

[DFO.NCRFFHPP-PPPHRCN.MPO@DFO-MPO.GC.CA](mailto:DFO.NCRFFHPP-PPPHRCN.MPO@DFO-MPO.GC.CA)

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